INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Economics

BUSINESS LAW AND ETHICS
TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 30 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 15 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Determine factors affecting business risk.
2. Identify factors affecting a business's profit.
3. Demonstrate connections between company actions and results.
4. Identify the company's brand promise.
5. Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of legal counsel and the marketing manager for NATURAL BITE, a company specializing in organic snacks. The CEO (judge) wants you to evaluate the legal implications of a new product launch while addressing key business metrics.

NATURAL BITE is a mid-sized company that specializes in organic snacks, founded with the mission of providing healthy, delicious, and sustainably sourced food options. The company prides itself on using high-quality ingredients, supporting local farmers, and minimizing its environmental impact. Its product line includes granola bars, trail mixes, and dried fruits, all of which are marketed as organic and health-conscious.

The new product line, PurePower Bars, are designed to be a convenient, on-the-go snack for health-conscious consumers, athletes, and busy professionals. Each bar is packed with protein (20 grams per bar), made from organic ingredients such as nuts, seeds, and natural sweeteners like honey or maple syrup. The bars are also gluten-free and contain no artificial additives or preservatives.

Key features of the PurePower Bars include its organic certification, gluten-free claims, flavor variety, and its nutritional benefits. Given the emphasis on organic and gluten-free claims, the company must ensure strict compliance with USDA and FDA regulations to avoid legal issues and maintain consumer trust. This requires accurate labeling, certification, and transparency in sourcing practices.

During the meeting with the CEO (judge), you must consider:

- The legal risks associated with product claims.
- How ensuring compliance can support the brand promise and profitability.
- The potential impact of market adaptation and competitive strategies.

You will present your analysis and recommendation to the CEO of NATURAL BITE (judge) in a meeting to take place in the CEO's (judge's) office. The CEO (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your analysis. After you have presented your analysis and recommendation and have answered the CEO's (judge's) questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Potential Judge's Questions:

1. How do you believe our commitment to organic and gluten-free certification will influence consumer trust?
2. What strategies do you recommend to differentiate the PurePower Bars from similar products?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Determine factors affecting business risk.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Identify factors affecting a business's profit.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Demonstrate connections between company actions and results.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Identify the company's brand promise.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	